

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

LAB 06 INSTRUCTIONS

For

Build a Headcount Analysis in Excel

Course Code: C197

Conducted by

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

Version 3.0

Lab 6 — Build a Headcount Analysis in Excel

Topic 03 · People Numbers and Reporting to Leadership · approximately 20 minutes

Where the files for this lab are

Every file this lab needs is inside one folder that came with your course materials. Open the labs folder, then open this folder inside it:

`labs/lab-06-build-a-headcount-analysis-in-excel/`

Do not look in any other lab folder. This lab is self-contained.

Files you will use, and what the steps call them

The steps below refer to these items in plain English. Use this table to find the exact file to open, and the exact sheet tab to click at the bottom of the Excel window.

The steps call it	App	Open this file	Then click
The workbook you complete in this lab	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-06-People-Numbers.xlsx	opens on the first tab
How this workbook is organised — read this tab first	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-06-People-Numbers.xlsx	the "Read_Me" tab
The staff data you analyse	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-06-People-Numbers.xlsx	the "Staff_List" tab
The assumptions used by every formula	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-06-People-Numbers.xlsx	the "Assumptions" tab
The analysis working area	Excel	Lumina-Living-Lab-06-People-Numbers.xlsx	the "Analysis" tab

Goal

Compare actual headcount and staff cost against plan, month by month and team by team, using formulas that point at the source data.

What you will produce

An analysis sheet where every result is a formula that points back to the source data.

Before you start

- Labs 1–6 completed.
- Open the supplied Finance Model workbook and Data Dictionary.
- Use only the fictional transaction data supplied in this lab.

Steps

Follow these in order. Where a shaded block appears, type or paste it exactly as shown into Claude, then read what Claude proposes before you accept anything.

1. Open Lumina-Living-Lab-06-People-Numbers.xlsx from this lab folder. Click the Staff_List tab to see the people data, then the Assumptions tab. Open the Claude panel in Excel.

2. Ask Claude to plan the analysis before it changes anything. Read the answer on screen.

Prompt to type into Claude:

Look at the Staff_List sheet and the Assumptions sheet in this open workbook. Tell me the formulas and checks you would use to compare actual headcount and staff cost against the plan, month by month and team by team. Name the sheets and columns you would use. Do not change the workbook yet.

3. Ask Claude to build the analysis with live formulas, not typed-in numbers.

Prompt to type into Claude:

On the Analysis sheet of this open workbook, build a comparison of actual headcount and staff cost against plan, by month and by team, using the Staff_List and Plan sheets. Show headcount, staff cost and the gap against plan. Use Excel formulas that point at the source data. Do not type in any total by hand. Keep every assumption on the Assumptions sheet.

4. Click into two of the result cells and read the formula bar. Check each one points at real data and is not a number someone typed.

5. Change one figure on the Assumptions tab and check the Analysis sheet updates. Write the check on the Checks tab.

Check your work

Two result cells checked in the formula bar show real formulas pointing at the source data, and changing an assumption updates the analysis.

If something goes wrong

- **A KPI does not recalculate.** Trace precedents and replace any pasted value with a formula tied to the approved table.
- **The variance sign is confusing.** Define favourable/unfavourable logic once and apply it consistently across tables, charts and narrative.
- **The dashboard is crowded.** Keep four KPIs and three decision charts; move details to Analysis and document definitions.

Challenge

Add a sensitivity table showing which assumption has the largest effect on Operating Contribution.

Reflection

Which model control gave you the strongest evidence that the dashboard can be trusted?